

news feed

DIGIT MARCH 2003

hypothesis

SongPro

■ What is it?

The idea of Ronald L. Jones, this is a Game Boy Advance (GBA) add-on that looks like a GBA cartridge. It can be used to download music that can be played on the GBA, and flash digital images of the CD covers corresponding to each song.

■ How does it work?

The SongPro fits into the game cartridge and comes with a USB link with which it can be connected to any Internet-connected PC for digital music downloads. The songs, song lyrics and CD covers, etc, can be downloaded from the homepage at www.songpro.com. It also comes with music management software. It utilises the GBA's 3-inch colour screen to display the digital images. It comes with a 32 MB Compact Flash card that provides the required memory for storage, and earphones.

■ What does it do?

The SongPro turns the Nintendo Game Boy Advance into an audio player. You can hear both MP3s and WMAs. The technology prevents unauthorised copying of copyrighted music. Future models of the SongPro will allow downloading and viewing multimedia files such as music videos and movie trailers.

Routers can be 'selfish'

Two Cornell University computer scientists have concluded that computer networks tend to be 'selfish' when they try to route traffic by the fastest pathway, leading to a congested and slow pathway. Researchers constructed a mathematical analysis of how routers direct packets and found that the average time of travel could be increased by up to 1.33 times compared with a regular system. Addition of more interconnections in the network could also be counterproductive because of an effect called Braess' paradox, the researchers said.

According to the paradox,

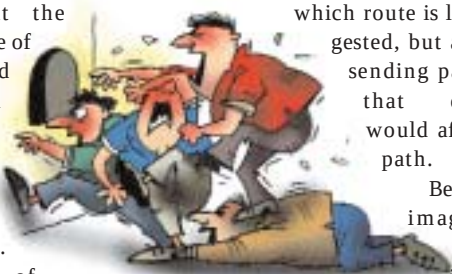
the packets of information would simply hop from one path to another—much like drivers switching lanes in a traffic jam—actually slowing down all the other packets traveling on those pathways.

To improve how routers direct traffic, they suggested that they consider not only which route is least congested, but also how sending packets in that direction would affect that path.

Being more imaginative,

a router in some cases may

end up choosing pathways that are not necessarily the fastest for delivering the packets, but which could still result in lower average times for all the transmitted data.



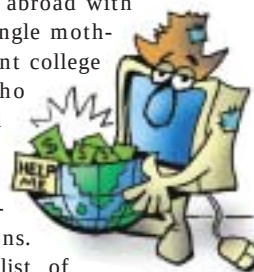
Now 'begging' in cyberspace too

The Internet is being used for what some now dub as 'cyberbegging'. This trend is catching on abroad with struggling single mothers and recent college graduates who are saddled with unpaid credit card bills and student loans. While the list of woes differs from site to site, they all ask for money via their home pages.

Christine Kent, for instance, has featured her cat at SaveBuster.com. She claims that her site actually raises money not for herself or Buster, but for a San Francisco non-profit organisation that helps people with AIDS and other illnesses keep their pets.

Observers, though, are skeptical that this is a genuine trend and are asking cyber-surfers to be wary of such sites.

Cyberbegging started gaining momentum late last year after US-based Karyn Bosnak asked for money to pay off his over \$20,000 debt.



New browser to rev up Internet experience

A 16-year-old Irish student, Osmani, has created a new Web browser that may be able to boost browsing times by up to 600 per cent. The browser claims to have 120 search engines, all the major media players, a DVD player, and an HTML and WAP editor built in. It is called the Xwebs Mega Browser.

Osmani said he has developed an algorithm that speeds up the way information is handled inside the browser. The

technique takes advantage of the features of a particular type of server used widely on the Internet.

The browser handles multiple requests for information, he said. So, instead of a single stream of information, several streams are processed simultaneously. In general, the task of bringing over a Web page is divided into a set of smaller tasks, cutting the time it takes to reassemble a Web page on the computer screen.

snapshot

At any given moment, **4 million** users use **KaZaA** to share over **800 million** files

Source: CNN

